

Editorial

Dear Readers,

So how will Oracle's takeover of Sun Microsystems affect the open source world? That's the question we were suddenly faced with just as we were going to press last month. All we could do was speculate on 'what's in it for us' in the OSS community. Which is why I promised LFY readers an in-depth review of this mega merger in this issue.

Swapnil Bhartiya, a senior journalist at EFY and a passionate proponent of free software, has more than delivered on that promise. Relentlessly pursuing global open source leaders for their inputs has ensured this story is a 'must read'. Its in-depth coverage will satisfy every open source enthusiast. Across pages 38 to 47, all implications of this deal have been explored, to give you a good insight on what's expected to happen to Sun's various open source projects, under the Oracle regime.

The significant news of this month (besides Deccan Chargers winning the IPL trophy) is Congress coming to power at the centre. While we would like to refrain from expressing our personal views on any particular political party, we are certainly excited about the fact that there is now a more stable government at the centre. Therefore, all decisions that require strong political will, can now be taken.

One of those decisions (we hope) will be to accelerate the adoption of open source within the government and public sector. Young leaders at the forefront and visionaries like Dr Manmohan Singh at the helm certainly add up to the right formation at the centre. There's another reason for hope—amongst the key personnel who advise the prime minister, we have Mr Prithviraj Chavan, who has been a vocal champion of open source for a very long time—he was talking about Linux and open source in Parliament even before *LINUX For You* was launched!

In fact, there's a lot of room for constructive opposition here. The BJP and the CPI(M) can play a major role in pushing the government to accelerate adoption of open source in India—after all, both had talked

about bringing in the 'open' wave in their manifestos. While they have not been granted the opportunity to execute their plans, they still have the power, and the responsibility, to push issues of national interest. Preventing the outflow of precious foreign exchange, promoting innovation and generating employment are just a few of the benefits that open source promises any nation. These three alone ought to make open source an issue of national interest.

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There's one more reason to cheer—we are about to re-launch LinuxForU.com. Expect it to go LIVE around mid-June. If you want to be amongst the first to get a sneak-peek, go to LinuxForU.com and drop us your e-mail ID. Before we go LIVE, we do plan on a 'premiere' for a select few. Those who register with us, will certainly be on that list. From what I have seen so far—this version rocks. But then, the final verdict is always yours.

Best Wishes!



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